

TO: Honorable Mayor and City Council

FROM: Pat McGinnis, City Manager

SUBJECT: Portage Road Lake Center Corridor Project - Tabulation of Engineering Proposals

SUPPORTING PERSONNEL: Peter Dame, Chief Development Officer
Kendra Gwin, Director of Transportation & Utilities

ACTION RECOMMENDED: Regarding the Portage Road Lake Center Corridor Project:

- a. Award a contract to perform design engineering services for Portage Road Lake Center Corridor to Wightman, of Kalamazoo, Michigan, in the not-to-exceed amount of \$1,406,888;
- b. Amend the Fiscal Year 2024-2025 Capital Improvement Program budget in the amount of \$400,000 to be funded via a Kalamazoo County Brownfield reimbursement related to the Lovers Lane 4-to-3 lane conversion and authorize the City Manager to execute all documents related to the contract on behalf of the city.

The Fiscal Year 2024-2025 Capital Improvement Program budget includes funding for design engineering of the Portage Road Lake Center Corridor Project. The Portage Road Lake Center Corridor is an important area within the City of Portage as Portage Road is a major arterial street that serves as a connection between residential, industrial, and commercial areas. The vision that was approved by City Council on July 13, 2021, of a more attractive, multimodal Portage Road anchored by the Lake Center Corridor will be the foundation of the design. This vision was reaffirmed in the Subarea Plan contained in the recently adopted 2024 Master Plan. A proactive design for the future of the Portage Road Lake Center Corridor will benefit the community, property owners, and area businesses and will create a vibrant and fulfilling environment.

On July 23, 2024, the city received four proposal for design engineering services for the Portage Road Lake Center Corridor Project. One of the proposals, EGIS BLN USA, was non-responsive to the requirements of the requested services. Upon initial review of the four proposals, it was also agreed that Abonmarche Consultants did not have the capacity to undertake such a major project at this time due to internal resources. Abonmarche voluntarily withdrew its proposal. City staff held interviews with the two most responsive consultants. Through the interview process, it was determined that the proposal from Wightman best fits the needs of the project.

While there was substantial public participation in the Lake Center District Corridor and Placemaking Study process, as part of the 2024 Portage Road Lake Center Corridor Reconstruction RAISE grant application denial debrief, the federal review committee thought the city's application was deficient in

public participation in the conceptual design. Wightman's proposal includes a comprehensive engagement process with the community instead of a direct-to-design approach which informs the public rather than engaging with them in meaningful conversation. The proposed approach focuses on building consensus and support for the desired project, provides opportunities for a two-way conversation, delivers a process for managing change, and allows for a non-linear design process to occur. Also, in the RAISE grant debrief, the city was found to be deficient in documenting a reduction in vehicle miles traveled. Wightman's proposal includes an entire network approach to the traffic study and analysis, including a comprehensive speed study. During the interview process, the staff was better able to define the expectations and scope of work, which prompted Wightman to reduce their proposal to \$1,406,888.

It is recommended that City Council award a contract to perform design engineering services for Portage Road Lake Center Corridor to Wightman, of Kalamazoo, Michigan, in the not-to-exceed amount of \$1,406,888, amend the Fiscal Year 2024-2025 Capital Improvement Program budget in the amount of \$400,000, and authorize the City Manager to execute all documents related to the contract on behalf of the city.

FUNDING: 2024-2025 Capital Improvement Program, including a \$400,000 budget amendment to be funded via a Kalamazoo County Brownfield reimbursement related to the Lovers Lane 4-to-3 lane conversion.

Attachments: 1. Bid Tab_2024 RFP Portage Road Lake Center Corridor

**2024 RFP PORTAGE ROAD LAKE CENTER CORRIDOR
PROFESSIONAL ENGINEERING SERVICES
PROPOSAL TABULATION**
PROPOSAL OPENING ON JULY 23, 2024 AT 3 PM

Abonmarche Consultants, Inc. 261 East Kalamazoo Avenue, Suite 100 Kalamazoo, MI 49007	\$	826,750.00
Prein&Newhof 3355 Evergreen Dr NE Grand Rapids, MI 49525	\$	829,900.00
Wightman 433 E. Ransom St. Kalamazoo, MI 49007	\$	1,522,308.00
Egis BLN USA, Inc. 8320 Craig Street Indianapolis, IN 46250		Non-Responsive

Opened by: 
Beth Hyland for Victoria Barboza, Purchasing Manager